Te Reo Māori Novice 1

Simplified unit plan

Course	Te Reo Māori Novice 1 (Path 1, Core / entry path)
Length	60 lessons · 2 lessons a week · one wāhanga per term, with buffer weeks
Lesson types	Core lesson 19 · Hokia (revision) 10 · Check-in 2 · Assessment 2 · Waiata · haka 8 · Practical 11 · Project 8
Curriculum	The New Zealand Curriculum – Learning Languages (Years 0–10), Te Reo Māori Novice, November 2026

Course overview

The entry path. Students learn the sounds of te reo Māori and te arapū, greet and introduce themselves and others, talk about whānau, numbers, age, places, days and months, classroom objects and what people are doing now. Karakia are learned early and used every lesson.

Teacher focus

Link te reo with the cultural values it carries. Help students notice how language varies across hapū, iwi and rohe. Show how values such as manaakitanga and whanaungatanga shape behaviour and relationships, and present te reo Māori as a living expression of identity, community and connection.

Term by term

Wāhanga	Learning (core lessons)	Key language	Waiata, practical, project	Assessment
Wāhanga 1 **Kia ora! Sounds, greetings and who I am** Term 1 · Lessons 1–15 N1.1 · N1.9 · N1.2	Kia ora! Greetings and farewells Te arapū Māori: vowels and macrons Tricky sounds and dialects Ngā mihi: writing a message Karakia for different purposes Ko wai tō ingoa? Introductions Kei te pēhea koe? How are you? Taku whānau: parents and caregivers	Kia ora · Tēnā koe · Te arapū Māori · Oro · Whakarongo · Ngā · Ngā mihi · Ngā mihi maioha · Karakia · Inoi · Ko wai tō ingoa? · Ko _____ taku ingoa	School waiata: meaning and tikanga Waiata: words and pronunciation Greeting stations Speed meeting 2 Hokia (revision) lessons	L15 Check-in 1
Wāhanga 2 **Numbers, age and places** Term 2 · Lessons 16–30 N1.3 · N1.4	Ngā tau: numbers 0–19 Numbers to 99 and counting things E hia ō tau? Age Kei hea tō kāinga? Significant places	Kore · Tahi · E hia? · Kotahi · Tau · E hia ō tau? · Kāinga · Kei hea?	Haka: tikanga and meaning Haka: words, rhythm and calls E hia ngā one ki Waiheke? Place-name hīkoi Ko wai au? · Plan Ko wai au? · Draft Ko wai au? · Make and rehearse Ko wai au? · Present 2 Hokia (revision) lessons	L26 Mid-course check

Wāhanga	Learning (core lessons)	Key language	Waiata, practical, project	Assessment
Wāhanga 3 **Days, months and the classroom** Term 3 · Lessons 31–45 N1.5 · N1.8 · N1.6	Ngā rā o te wiki: days of the week Ngā marama: months of the year Classroom language He aha tēnei? Naming and describing things Kei hea te pene? Where things are Tēnei, tēnā, tērā	Mane / Rāhina · Tūrei / Rātū · Marama · Hānuere · Whakarongo mai · Titiro mai · He aha tēnei? · Pene · Kei hea? · Runga · Tēnei / ēnei · Tēnā / ēnā	Waiata ā-ringa: actions with meaning Haka: stance, actions and wiri Our bilingual calendar Label the classroom Treasure hunt 3 Hokia (revision) lessons	L40 Check-in 2
Wāhanga 4 **Doing things and showing our learning** Term 4 · Lessons 46–60 N1.7	Kei te aha koe? Activities now	Kei te aha koe? · Tuhi	Poi and waiata ā-ringa: te reo only Performance: waiata and haka Action relay Greetings comic strip Kōrero rehearsal Whakanui: celebrate and look ahead Te reo in our school · Research Te reo in our school · Design and check Te reo in our school · Make Te reo in our school · Put up and reflect 3 Hokia (revision) lessons	L59 Final assessment: Ko wai au?

Curriculum practices

- **N1.1** Greetings and farewells; pronunciation
- **N1.2** Introduce self and others; how are you; parents/caregivers
- **N1.3** Number and age
- **N1.4** Significant places
- **N1.5** Days of the week and months
- **N1.6** Where things are located
- **N1.7** Activities in the present
- **N1.8** Simple classroom language
- **N1.9** Karakia for different purposes

Assessment

- Formative: success criteria and a Review stage in every lesson; check-ins every 12–15 lessons; Hokia lessons revisit the previous run of lessons.
- Summative: mid-course and final assessments (listening, reading, writing and kōrero), judged with the course rubric.
- Judgements use the five progress descriptors: Emerging, Developing, Consolidating, Proficient, Exceeding. Proficient means meeting the expectations of this course.
- Rubric criteria: Kōrero: greetings and questions; Pronunciation; Communication strategies; Tuhi: writing; Tikanga.

Communication skills (examples)

- **Listening:** Identify the sounds of the letters of the Māori alphabet (arapū), letter combinations, intonation and stress patterns
- **Reading:** Identify the letters of the Māori alphabet (te arapū Māori)
- **Speaking:** Imitate the pronunciation, intonation, stress and rhythm of Māori words, phrases and sentences
- **Writing:** Write vowels with macrons where appropriate
- **Interacting:** Start spoken exchanges in te reo Māori using simple greetings, questions and statements

Tikanga and values

- Karakia open and close every lesson, led by students once taught.
- Manaakitanga and whanaungatanga shape how we greet, host and work together.
- Mita and local rohe: invite mana whenua knowledge and use local examples where possible.
- Waiata and haka are practised regularly, with their meaning and tikanga.

Resources	Notes for this year
• Slideshows (PDF, PowerPoint, Google Slides) and worksheets (PDF, Word, Google Docs) for every lesson; a course workbook and answer keys. • Te Reo Wero online kēmu with a Novice 1 mode; adventure games Te Haerenga, Kōrero Mai and Te Kete Ngaro. • Physical classroom games with printables (bingo, sentence cards, postcard hunt). • Te Aka Māori Dictionary for audio and checking words; the Āwhina kaiako page for teacher support.	• • •